

# Of near misses and a perfect hit

Some people have the knack of making the best of a situation, as also the knack of making friends...

Adarsh Kaul, from our events team, is the kind who never misses the bus...or the train for that matter. So what if he and his colleagues in the events team had been totally immersed in planning and organising a massive-scale event like Planet Digit, which was held in July in Bangalore, Delhi and Mumbai.

The final details had to be sorted at the respective venues. With only days left to go for the first Planet Digit in Bangalore and still so much do Adarsh was to be the man on the spot to ensure that everything ran smoothly.

But on the day of the departure, Adarsh was still busy tying up all the loose ends and lost track of the time; 5 pm and he was still running about getting things done, when he bumped into Kaustubh, also from the events team, and Jasmine, our International Marketing manager. "Arrey, what are you doing here? Don't you have a train to catch?" asked Kaustubh. "Show me your ticket," said Jasmine. Rushed for work, Adarsh fished out his ticket and gave it to them to see the time printed on it, which said 1900 hours.

"Oh my God! Only 2 hours for the train to leave. You better get going man! It's been pouring all day and there's bound to be traffic snarl

ups. As it is, it takes an hour and half to get to Mumbai Central from the office."

So his colleagues bundled him into a cab and sent him on his way. And Adarsh made it to the station by the skin of his teeth, with seconds to spare for the scheduled departure time. Only to find there was no sign of the train he was supposed to catch. Sure that the train was late, he marched straight to the station master wanting to know how late the train was going to be. "What are you talking about? That train leaves at 10 pm!" says the station master. "But my ticket says 7 p.m.," said Adarsh.

The puzzled station master asked to see his ticket and burst out laughing...the time printed on the ticket was the time of booking! With the fine print saying that the train timings had changed effective July 1 and that the passenger should check the new schedules. Both had a hearty laugh. With over 3 hours for the train to leave and nothing to do, Adarsh struck up a friendship with the station master and passed time. We, of course, will not talk about the berating some people got for landing him in that situation. All we'll say is that Adarsh is not one to miss the bus, or the train...

## Adarsh meets Adarsh

But that's not the end of Adarsh's experiences. In Bangalore at Planet Digit, Adarsh struck up a friendship of a different sort.

Among the throngs of visitors, he came across a young lad, all of 14 years, and coincidentally also named Adarsh. The two hit it off right away and the younger namesake was taken under the wing by the 'elderly 25-year-old' Adarsh. Now 14-year-old Adarsh is a big fan of India's favourite technology magazine and was keen to meet everybody associated



Need we say who's who—Adarsh with Adarsh

with Digit. So he was introduced to the rest of the team members present at the event. Everybody was much taken by the young guy's enthusiasm and love for Digit and he was treated like one of the family throughout the day. But the depth of his attachment to Digit was brought home only when the day came to an end and it was time to pack up. Young Adarsh literally had tears in his eyes, when the good byes were being said. And his older namesake, who we must add is never at a loss for words, was extremely touched, as was everybody else.